ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** loss is a way of gaining knowledge	Knowledge through loss.
2	**(d)** everything lost can be replaced	Replacement.
3	**(a)** had not lost	Third conditional.
4	**(a)** respectful and sympathetic	Stance.
5	**(d)** empathetic restraint	He respects.
6	**(d)** a call to resilience	Counsel.
7	**(a)** a relative clause	Defining.
8	**(d)** question to reflection to counsel	Pattern.
9	**(c)** stoic acceptance	Stoic.
10	**(b)** patient and uncomplaining	Endures.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It describes the ball's happy motion (1) but also anticipates the sorrow that follows (1).	1+1
12	Standing suggests resilience (1) in the face of emotional collapse (1).	1+1
13	Short, questioning phrases (1) show hesitation and shock (1).	1+1
14	Replacement denies the reality of loss (1) and prevents the boy's moral growth (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It rejects false comfort (1). It values empathy and silence (1). It suggests that growth is internal (1).	1+1+1
16	The ball is small and personal (1). The harbour is vast and indifferent (1). Together they show innocence meeting the world (1).	1+1+1
17	The boy realises for the first time (1) that one must be responsible for what one owns (1) and that things can be lost (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Loss is negative (1). But gives knowledge and strength (1). The paradox is resolved in maturity (1).	1+1+1
18	The poet says words cannot console (1). Silence is better (1). Language only observes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The boy cried whereas the ball floated away (1). In spite of his grief, he stood (1). As soon as the ball fell, he froze (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	The incident (1). Boy's grief (1). Poet's reflections (1). Universal meaning (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Scene (1). Camera angles (1). Dialogue or silence (1). Sound (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
20	Theme (1). Symbols (1). Tone (1). Language (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Rhetorical questions (1). Concern (1). Reader involvement (1). Structure (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** emotional attachment	Inner value.
2	**(c)** simplicity of incident and depth of reflection	Mix.
3	**(d)** Growth comes through bearing loss	Moral.
4	**(a)** turns sorrow into insight	Philosophical.
5	**(c)** generic 'boy' and common experience	Universal.
6	**(d)** a comic tone	It is not comic.
7	**(a)** the boy's sorrow is complete and overwhelming	Intensity of grief.
8	**(c)** an ethical stance of non-intrusion	Respect.
9	**(a)** empathy and resilience	Value education.
10	**(b)** a mark of authentic grief	Silent sorrow.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The poet reflects on loss (1) but the boy remains the central figure (1).	1+1
12	It reflects the ongoing nature of grief (1) and leaves readers reflecting (1).	1+1
13	It is a vast, uncontrollable space (1) that symbolises forces we cannot recover from (1).	1+1
14	Simple words keep the emotion honest (1) and let the idea resonate (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Plain words (1). No melodrama (1). The emotion is felt through restraint (1).	1+1+1
16	More immediate and emotional (1). Less reflective (1). The adult wisdom would be lost (1).	1+1+1
17	forlorn, bereft, disconsolate (1). The boy looked forlorn (1). Each shows a degree of sorrow (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A child's grief is pure (1). It is the first experience (1). It shows how growth begins (1).	1+1+1
18	It shows empathy (1). It values feeling (1). It models respectful behaviour (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Rhetorical question (1). Symbolism of ball (1). They deepen emotion (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Sympathy (1). Detachment (1). Language (1). Effect (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Reasons for (1). Reasons against (1). Poem's logic (1). Modern view (1). Judgement (1).	2+2+1
20	Ball: acceptance (1). Letter: faith (1). Sermon: universality of death (1). Differences (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Setting (1). Character (1). Loss (1). Reaction (1). Learning (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** The poem links psychological growth with loss	Valid.
2	**(a)** open and uncertain but hopeful	Open.
3	**(a)** colloquial yet reflective diction	Style.
4	**(c)** early experience of loss and resilience	Developmental.
5	**(a)** A Lesson in Loss	Matches theme.
6	**(c)** trivialises children's grief	Social comment.
7	**(d)** the poet's anxious empathy	Concern.
8	**(a)** ironic in hindsight	Irony.
9	**(b)** irreversible loss	Foreshadowing.
10	**(d)** Never before had the boy felt such grief.	Inversion after 'never before'.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It presents an incident and a thought (1) rather than a lecture (1).	1+1
12	The observer watches silently (1) and shows respect through non-intervention (1).	1+1
13	It reminds us not to treat everything as replaceable (1) and values emotional bonds (1).	1+1
14	The child feels it sharply (1) while adults may minimise it, which the poet criticises (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It denies replacement as solution (1). It values inner worth (1). It resists a throwaway attitude (1).	1+1+1
16	Grief cannot be bought off (1). No price can heal a heart (1). Wealth is powerless before sorrow (1).	1+1+1
17	A silent boy at the harbour (1). The ball bouncing (1). The poet's voice-over (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Street and harbour are public (1). The grief is private (1). The poet bridges the two (1).	1+1+1
18	The poet said to the boy, 'You will learn to stand up.' (1). Quotation marks (1). Pronoun changes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: 'The Price of a Lost Ball' (1). It plays on money and loss (1). It reflects the poem's irony (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Intro (1). Consumerism (1). Poem's view (1). Examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Personal voice (1). Small event (1). Reflection (1). Universal (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Greeting (1). Poem (1). Key lessons (1). Practical tips (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Theme (1). Methods (1). Challenges (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.